

# Armored Cars and Troop Carriers

World War II saw the widespread use of armored vehicles in a variety of roles. Scout Cars, Light Reconnaissance cars, and Armored Cars were used for reconnaissance and to provide armored support to infantry. Some carried light firepower, while other variants were as well armed as contemporary tanks. Their main role was to find the enemy and survive to report back, so binoculars, a radio, and good tactics were their main weapons.

▷ **Sd Kfz 231 Schwerer Panzerspahwagen, 8-rad**

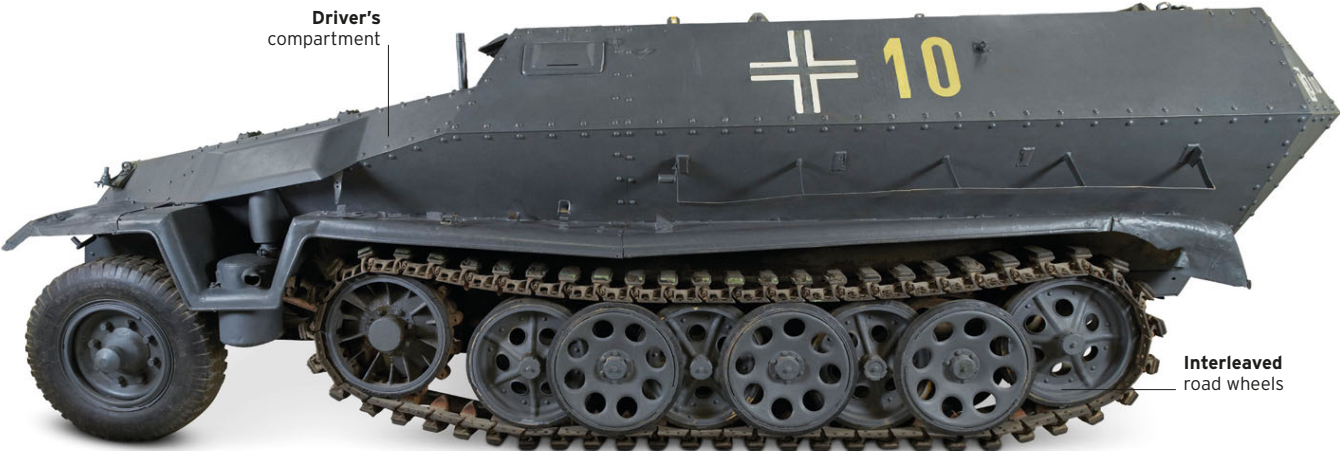
Date 1936 Country Germany

Weight 9.3 tons (8.4 tonnes)

Engine Bussing-NAG L8V gasoline, 155hp

Main armament 2 cm KwK 30 L/55 cannon

The prewar 6x4 Panzerspahwagen lacked sufficient cross-country mobility, and were replaced by these eight-wheeled vehicles. Their roles and armament remained the same, and they kept the rear driver's position. Some variants carried the large "bedstead" radio aerial, while others were upgraded with a 7.5 cm KwK 37 gun.



◁ **Sd Kfz 251/8 Mittlere Krankenpanzerwagen Ausf C**

Date 1939 Country Germany

Weight 8.7 tons (7.9 tonnes)

Engine Maybach HL42 TUKRM gasoline, 100 hp

Main armament None

Designed as an armored personnel carrier for German Panzergrenadiers to accompany the tanks, this vehicle had a capacity to carry 10 infantrymen. It was well armored, but open-topped, and its half-track design gave it good cross-country mobility. More than 15,000 of these were built, including around 2,500 in postwar Czechoslovakia.

▷ **Universal Carrier, Mark II**

Date 1939 Country UK

Weight 4.4 tons (4 tonnes)

Engine Ford flathead V8 gasoline, 85hp

Main armament .303 Bren machine gun

One of the most-produced armored vehicles in history, the Universal Carrier descended from the Carden-Loyd (see pp.46-47). A number of different carriers were developed and amalgamated into one "universal" design. Highly versatile, it was used to carry machine guns, mortars, infantrymen, supplies and artillery observation equipment, among other roles. Carriers were popular with the infantry and in high demand.

